

Prompts that materially shaped HireFlow

A curated record of the prompts and corrections that changed the product definition, Copilot interaction model, prototype architecture and final UI. Routine implementation commands, deployment retries, lint/build output and minor spacing fixes are intentionally omitted.

Scope note

This is not the complete working transcript. ChatGPT entries are condensed from the design working session; Claude Code entries preserve the key wording from the build history.

How the work moved

01	Frame	Persona, scope, assumptions
02	Model	Conversation vs structured UI
03	Build	Shared state + Copilot architecture
04	Correct	Stop unnecessary navigation
05	Systemize	IA, engineering and UI rules
06	Freeze	Audit, verify and polish

Start from the hiring manager, not the ATS

Why this prompt mattered

The first step was to stop treating the brief as a screen redesign and define whose decision we were improving.

SELECTED PROMPT

Use one hiring-manager persona. Priya may manage multiple roles at the same time, and hiring is only one part of her job. Her core job is: help me understand who deserves my attention, why, and what I need to do next. Map her current journey before proposing the AI-native experience.

What changed

Established Priya, multi-role context, the current journey and the problem framing used throughout the prototype.

Decide what belongs in chat vs. UI

Why this prompt mattered

The assignment explicitly tests whether conversation is used deliberately rather than added as a generic assistant.

SELECTED PROMPT

Do not make the whole ATS a chatbot. Conversation should express intent and support investigation. Structured UI should remain for scanning, evidence, comparison and persistent state. Both should work on the same product state.

What changed

Created the principle: Chat for intent. UI for evidence. Human for decisions. This became the basis for Manual, Conversational and Hybrid routes.

Make AI recommendations inspectable

Why this prompt mattered

A hiring recommendation needed to be useful without becoming an opaque verdict.

SELECTED PROMPT

Avoid making an 87% AI score the hero. Prefer a recommendation such as Strong match - 4/5 priorities supported by evidence. Show evidence per configured criterion, expose uncertainty, distinguish missing evidence from negative evidence, and keep the source accessible.

What changed

Candidate review shifted from a score-led profile to an evidence workspace with visible uncertainty and source grounding.

04 / CLAUDE CODE · SELECTED EXCERPT

Separate global IA from role workspace IA

Why this prompt mattered

The first prototype duplicated Candidates, Pipeline and Interviews at both global and role levels.

SELECTED PROMPT

The current navigation architecture is incorrect... GLOBAL navigation and ROLE navigation must be completely separated. Remove Candidates, Pipeline, Interviews and Hiring Criteria from the global sidebar. They belong inside a role. Sidebar = location in PRODUCT. Tabs = location inside CURRENT ROLE.

What changed

Global navigation became Home / My Openings / Copilot / Notifications, while role tabs handled Overview / Candidates / Pipeline / Interviews / Hiring Criteria.

05 / CLAUDE CODE · SELECTED EXCERPT

Turn Copilot into an operating layer

Why this prompt mattered

The assistant initially behaved too much like a help layer attached to the ATS.

SELECTED PROMPT

Copilot must do more than answer questions. There are THREE behavior classes: UNDERSTAND, MANIPULATE VIEW, and MUTATE PRODUCT DATA. Reversible view operations do not require confirmation. Consequential changes require confirmation. Copilot and manual UI share ONE state.

What changed

Copilot could answer, filter the current screen, and prepare/execute confirmed hiring actions against shared state.

Stop Copilot from navigating unnecessarily

Why this prompt mattered

A major conceptual problem appeared: AI actions were sending Priya back into traditional screens instead of continuing the workflow conversationally.

SELECTED PROMPT

If Copilot says '2 interviews need your feedback' and Priya clicks 'Review interviews', DO NOT automatically send her to another product page. Continue the workflow inside Copilot... Only navigate when Priya explicitly says 'Open Nisha', 'Take me to Pipeline', or 'Show this in Candidates'.

What changed

Review, compare and investigate stayed inside Copilot by default. Navigation became an explicit secondary action.

Dock contextual Copilot beside the product

Why this prompt mattered

A floating overlay hid the interface that Copilot was supposed to help operate.

SELECTED PROMPT

DO NOT COVER THE PRODUCT. Open a DOCKED RIGHT PANEL. Global sidebar + current workspace + Copilot side panel. The workspace should resize. Context must always be visible. Expand opens the SAME conversation in the full Copilot workspace and preserves role context, candidate context, filters, investigation and pending action.

What changed

Created two presentations of one Copilot: full workspace and contextual docked panel, with shared history and visible context.

Move from screen fixes to a product system

Why this prompt mattered

The prototype was becoming visually and structurally inconsistent when individual prompts tried to fix individual screens.

SELECTED PROMPT

We need one coordinated PRODUCT ARCHITECTURE + UX + VISUAL SYSTEM + OPERATIONAL DEPTH pass. Do NOT treat this as 'make the UI prettier.' Correct information architecture, interaction, component, density and visual-quality problems together. Preserve the core concept.

What changed

The work shifted from local UI corrections to explicit product architecture, shared-state, engineering and UI requirement documents.

09 / CLAUDE CODE · SELECTED EXCERPT

Audit the whole product without expanding scope

Why this prompt mattered

The final pass needed to improve credibility and consistency without turning the exercise into a full ATS build.

SELECTED PROMPT

Perform a FINAL COMPREHENSIVE UX/UI AUDIT AND REFINEMENT of the existing functional ATS prototype. Do NOT redesign the concept from scratch. Do NOT break working functionality. Fix information architecture, navigation hierarchy, Copilot behavior, page-level information design, visual hierarchy, component quality, interaction states, accessibility, responsive behavior, consistency and product realism.

What changed

Produced the final system-wide refinement while preserving the existing product model and working flows.

10 / CLAUDE CODE · SELECTED EXCERPT

Freeze the product around the assignment

Why this prompt mattered

The last step was to stop adding features and make the prototype small, coherent and internally consistent.

SELECTED PROMPT

THIS IS THE FINAL PRODUCT PASS. Do NOT add new major modules. Do NOT expand scope. The goal is not 'more features.' The goal is a SMALL, COHERENT, BELIEVABLE, AI-NATIVE HIRING MANAGER EXPERIENCE. The evaluation is not about how many ATS features we can build. Did we rethink the interaction?

What changed

Scope was frozen around the three required moments and the core interaction model.

Fix one source of truth before submission

Why this prompt mattered

A final audit found that pipeline counts were being represented inconsistently across pages.

SELECTED PROMPT

Candidate state must have one canonical source. Do NOT hardcode conflicting counts across pages. Derive stage counts, role counts, pipeline counts, attention counts and interview counts from shared state where practical. If Ananya moves from HM Review to Interview, every relevant surface must update.

What changed

Final verification focused on state consistency across Candidate Detail, Candidates, Pipeline, Overview, Copilot and Activity.

REFLECTION

What changed in the way AI was used

The strongest iterations did not come from asking AI for more screens. They came from making the product model more explicit: who the user is, what context is active, what AI may change without confirmation, what requires human approval, and which state is shared across the interface.

Early	Prompt for a screen or feature	Useful output, but local decisions drifted.
Middle	Prompt with product + behavior rules	Copilot and structured UI began behaving as one system.
Later	Prompt against UXRD + AI behavior + engineering proto constraints	The proto became more coherent and easier to audit.

Final takeaway: AI accelerated execution, but the product improved when design judgment was translated into constraints the AI could repeatedly follow.